

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto and previously with Metrolinx on the GO rail network. Reviews consultant studies, engineering submissions and drawings against standards, runs assigned projects from scoping to recommendations, and coordinates with municipal, agency and consultant stakeholders.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Review engineering submissions, consultant studies and drawings against City standards and policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule and quality myself and reporting progress to the people relying on it.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a resolution.
- Write the memos, briefing notes and presentations that carry plans, issues and recommendations to management.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, combining several years of data from separate sources into one validated source the division reports from.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what infrastructure constraints and speed restrictions would do to run times and reliability.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers to settle the variables a service plan had to be built on.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Review of engineering submissions, consultant studies and drawings. Project scoping, scheduling and follow-through. Stakeholder coordination with municipal divisions, agencies and consultants. OpenTrack rail simulation, VISSIM and Synchro. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, ArcGIS and QGIS. Memos, briefing notes and presentations. MS Office.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)